



place. I would want to see a stronger role of the Competition Commission [of India] to ensure there is fair play in the marketplace... It's good to see a few big successes, but how do we multiply them exponentially?

Q: You spoke of a few big industrial groups. Now, Jio is entering financial services. How do you see that play out?

A: I just want to clarify that I have great respect for what Reliance or any of these big houses have built. They've created world-class institutions... But I believe that in addition to what they've done, India needs a lot more... Specifically with reference to Jio's entry into financial services, I think that's a very good thing. Because you want people in any sector to always be on the edge; [the] moment you get complacent, things don't move. And being on the edge is critical for any company's future. And I believe in the line, 'only the paranoid survive'. And if you're paranoid, you will survive. If you're not, you don't need to be in the business.

Q: Are we building enough financial sector infrastructure to power the kind of growth the Indian economy is anticipating?

A: I must first compliment the Reserve Bank of India for a phenomenal job in the last three years... the way it has navigated India through these difficult times, particularly in the areas of monetary policy and macroeco-

nomie stability. The RBI has played a very significant role in the health of the Indian banking sector... The question we have to ask for the future is what are we doing for our aspirations? And this is where I think there is an opportunity for Indian bankers and policymakers to manage risks but get a little bolder. Yes, we want to minimise accidents on the road. The way to do it is to have better traffic signals, better supervision, and better regulation. But, we must encourage a lot more cars on the road and lot more roads to be built.

Q: Could you suggest a few pain points where you'd like RBI to let bankers do their thing?

A: I find RBI [to be] very flexible and open to suggestions. If I take the liberty of giving suggestions, one area India needs to be ready for is acquisition finance. How can Indian firms get acquisition finance from Indian banks? Today, if a company wants to buy another company in India, they're dependent on foreign banks or sources outside India. The current limitation of lending against shares, even for acquisition, is a limit which was fixed in 1992 of ₹20 lakh per individual... Access to finance is going to be one of the most important differentiators for building an India of the future. And we need to make that easily available with guardrails for risk. Risk management is the core of any leveraged finance business. But along with that, we need to make it available for Indian entrepreneurs to get to scale.